Some documentation topics

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This is a discussion session

...jump in anytime...



Infrastructure thrashing

Docs build system moved to Python

- kernel-doc.pl is gone!

sphinx-build-wrapper in 6.19

Tools moved to .../tools/docs



On Python code in the kernel

Coding style?

Where do modules live?

- Put into tools/lib/python

There’s lots of other Python code around



Sphinx has gotten faster!

Version	Build time (s1)	(s2)
4.5.0		25:09
5.3.0		25:53
6.2.1	4:48	28:04
7.4.7	2:59	9:24
8.1.3	2:56	



Pain point: PDF generation

How many people still use it?

(I wish rst2pdf worked...)



Support for documentation

There is nobody whose job is to
do kernel documentation



As a result, we have...

Lots of outdated documentation
Lots of missing documentation
An unordered mess of material
Minimal orientation toward readership



We really need a technical writer dedicated to help keeping the in-kernel documentation up to date and relevant. The kernel developers are much better at writing code than documenting it, and if there was someone watching over this, and bugging the developers to keep it up to date when it lapses, it would help out immensely.

— Greg Kroah-Hartman, 2006



Outside help

Attempts to bring in outside help have failed

...not entirely sure why



LLM-generated docs?

Not happening so far

What should our policy be?



Hierarchy

v3.18: 253 entries in Documentation/
v6.18: 87

...still too many



The culprit: device documentation

Split entries across books?

...or create Documentation/devices?



Maintainership

I’ve been doing this for 11 years

It’s time to be thinking about transitions

Thanks to Alex Shi for taking on Chinese!



Translations

Language	Files	General state
Chinese	332	Active
Chinese (trad)	97	Almost abandoned
Korean	5	Abandoned
Italian	67	Occasional updates
Japanese	7	Abandoned
Spanish	37	Rare updates



What else?

